

Anxiety, Fear, and the Peace of God

The most repeated command in Scripture is do not be afraid, and it is never spoken to people who have nothing to fear.

Text. Selected texts on fear and peace

Good for. Anxious believers who feel guilty for being afraid

The arc. Scripture never shames the fearful. It speaks to them, names the fear, and points to a God who is present, sovereign, and near. This series moves from the command not to fear, through the practice of prayer, to the peace that guards a heart it does not explain.

1. Fear Not, for I Am With You

Isaiah 41:8-13

Big idea. God commands His people not to fear by promising His presence, His help, and His upholding hand.

Aim. To answer the hearer's fear with the fact of God's nearness.

Notes

2. Do Not Be Anxious About Your Life

Matthew 6:25-34

Big idea. The Father who clothes the grass knows what His children need, and anxiety about tomorrow forgets who holds it.

Aim. To move the hearer's worry from the future to the Father who owns it.

Notes

3. Cast Your Cares

1 Peter 5:6-11

Big idea. We humble ourselves and throw our anxiety onto God precisely because He cares for us, not because the danger is small.

Aim. To give the hearer somewhere to put the weight instead of carrying it.

Notes

4. The Peace That Guards the Heart

Philippians 4:4-9

Big idea. Prayer with thanksgiving opens the door to a peace beyond understanding that stands guard over heart and mind.

Aim. To hand the hearer a practice for the next anxious night.

Notes

5. Through the Valley

Psalm 23:1-6

Big idea. Even through the darkest valley the shepherd is present, and His rod and staff turn terror into comfort.

Aim. To walk the hearer through their fear with a shepherd they can name.

Notes

HOW TO USE THIS SERIES

These are starting points, not scripts. Each series gives you the arc, the divisions, and a working aim for every sermon, but the breakdown here is scaffolding you will take down once the text has done its own work in you. Read the whole book before you preach the first week of it. Let the passage divisions teach you where the seams actually are.

The text sets the agenda. Not the felt needs you arrived with, not the outline that looks clean on a slide, not the application you already know you want to land. Sit under the passage long enough for it to surprise you, and then preach what it says rather than what you planned. A big idea you did not have to fight for is usually one the text did not give you.